DAY 28 | PRE-READ

Common Languages for AI

A light read before Day 28. About 15 minutes, no code required.

Prepared by **Ahmed** | linkedin.com/in/ahmed-al-imaad

Why read this?

As AI agents spread, they need standard ways to connect to tools and to each other. Today you meet two important standards and build two advanced patterns: handing work over cleanly, and an agent that analyses data safely.

1. One plug for many devices

Before USB, every printer, mouse and camera had its own cable. USB made one plug work everywhere. The **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** does this for AI: a company exposes its systems once as an MCP server, and any AI application that speaks MCP can use them, including coding tools such as OpenAI Codex.

2. Agents talking to agents

Your travel agent calls an airline's booking desk. Each side has its own systems and rules; they agree on how to make and track requests. **Agent-to-Agent (A2A)** is an open protocol for this between AI agents.

Standard	Connects	Everyday comparison
MCP	An AI app to tools and data	Plugging a device into a USB port
A2A	One AI agent to another agent	Your agent phoning another company's agent

3. Checking the badge NEW (v4)

You would not hand a parcel to someone just because they say they are a courier; you check the badge. In A2A v1.0, an agent's description (its **Agent Card**) can be **signed**, so other agents can check it really comes from who it claims. MCP servers on the internet now check a **token** on every request, like a visitor pass with an expiry time.

4. An AI data analyst in a locked room NEW (v4)

Ask "Which city sold the most last month?" and an AI writes the code, runs it and explains the answer. Powerful, and risky. The code must run in a **sandbox**: a locked room with no internet, a time limit and only the approved data. The answer should show its working so people can check it.

Key idea: standards make AI easier to connect; security rules make it safe to connect.

5. Think about these before class

- Which SmartDesk systems would you expose to AI first, and which never?
- Describe a handoff you received that was done badly. What was missing?
- How would you check that an AI's number is correct?

Tsunagu (繋ぐ): to connect